PSYCHOLOGICAL/COGNITIVE FALSE BELIEF #13 · CLOSENESS AND CONNECTION · DEPENDING CAUSES TROUBLE

“Depending on anyone only leads to trouble.”

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Do you hesitate to count on anyone because you expect to be let down? Do you feel that depending on others only leads to trouble? The information below is intended to help you take a step toward trusting dependable people again, and to find the security that comes from knowing God’s word as found in the Bible.

Where it often comes from

When people who should have been dependable were absent, unpredictable, or let us down, we learn that depending on others ends in disappointment. A child who had to take care of herself or himself too early can decide that needing anyone is dangerous. Self-reliance then feels like wisdom.

How the belief can keep itself going

If we never depend on anyone, no one has the chance to prove reliable. Every close call is remembered, and every kept promise goes unnoticed. We also take on everything alone, which can lead to exhaustion and loneliness, and that seems to confirm that people are not worth the trouble.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture teaches that two are better than one, and that a companion can lift us up when we fall. Our first dependence is on God, who is faithful when people are not, and He often helps us through the people He sends. We are also told to carry one another’s burdens. These passages do not say every person is reliable, but they show that wise, careful dependence is part of God’s design.

> *“Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10)*

Also see

> “And though one may be overpowered, two can resist. Moreover, a cord of three strands is not quickly broken.” (Ecclesiastes 4:12)

> “A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother.” (Proverbs 18:24)

> “Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge.” (Psalm 62:8)

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” (Galatians 6:2)

Common self-statements

- If I rely on someone, they will let me down.
- It is safer to do everything myself.
- Needing people just creates problems.
- I do not ask for help.
- People are only reliable until they are not.

- I would rather struggle alone than owe anyone.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Concluding that everyone is undependable because some people were.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must depend on nobody or depend on everybody.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that anyone I rely on will fail me.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking times when someone came through.
- Catastrophizing: Treating any disappointment as a disaster.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling uneasy about needing someone and concluding it is unsafe.

Challenging questions

- Who failed me in the past, and are all people like them?
- Can I recall someone who was dependable?
- What does doing everything alone cost me?
- Could I depend on a person a little, in a small, low-risk way?
- Is there a difference between wise and foolish dependence?
- How has God been faithful when people were not?
- What would I tell a friend who was exhausted from carrying everything alone?

Truth summary

Some people have let me down, but not everyone will. I can depend on others carefully, a little at a time, and learn who is trustworthy. I can depend on God completely. Relying on others is not foolish when I choose wisely, and it can lighten what I was never meant to carry alone.

A short prayer

Lord, You are faithful when people are not. Heal the hurt of those who let me down. Teach me to rely on You first, and give me wisdom to find trustworthy people and the courage to lean on them a little. Amen.

Related Pearls topics

Open these topics in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Help
- Strength

Godly Counsel Lessons — read or print:

- Communication
- Anxiety, Worry, Fear
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes
>
> Your browser cannot play this audio.

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Click a picture to play inside this card. Each selection is an official lyric video with words on screen.

Trust in God
Elevation Worship feat. Chris Brown

Reflect on trusting God, who never fails.

Goodness of God
CeCe Winans

Remember God's goodness as you learn to trust again.

Known
Tauren Wells

Rest in being known and cared for.

Truth Be Told
Matthew West & Carly Pearce

Practice honesty about the burdens you carry.

YouTube may show ads.

Clinical background

For counselors: beliefs like this are often discussed in connection with what clinicians call schizoid personality disorder, a long-standing pattern of detachment from close relationships and a narrow range of expressed emotion. This card follows Identify → Challenge → Replace, using evidence review, balanced alternatives, daily rehearsal, and small behavioral experiments. Extreme self-reliance often reflects early disappointment; graded, low-risk experiences of reliability are more helpful than arguing the belief away. This is an individualized educational formulation, not a DSM criterion or a diagnostic test. Similar presentations can arise from depression, trauma, social anxiety, autism spectrum differences, or temperament, so careful assessment matters. Pace any experiments to the person; someone with severe depression or thoughts of self-harm should seek professional help.

Beck Institute: Personality Belief Questionnaire materials · Beck, Davis, & Freeman, Cognitive Therapy of Personality Disorders

Each morning ask: "Is there one small thing I could let someone else help with today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Depending on anyone only leads to trouble."

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Check one choice in each section or write your own. Choose a question and a truth that feel meaningful to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it from 0% to 100%.

> "Depending on anyone only leads to trouble." I believe this _____ %.

2 My best question

Select a question to ask when you feel you must handle everything alone.

- ☐ Who failed me in the past, and are all people like them?
- ☐ Can I recall someone who was dependable?
- ☐ What does doing everything alone cost me?
- ☐ Could I depend on a person a little, in a small, low-risk way?
- ☐ Is there a difference between wise and foolish dependence?
- ☐ How has God been faithful when people were not?

My own question:

3 My replacement truth

Select a balanced statement to practice.

- ☐ Some people let me down, but not everyone will.
- ☐ I can depend on others a little at a time and learn who is trustworthy.
- ☐ I can depend on God fully.
- ☐ Asking for help is wise, not weak.
- ☐ I was not meant to carry everything alone.
- ☐ Trust can be built in small steps.

In my own words:

4 My Scripture

Choose one passage to remember; these are the same passages shown on the card.

- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:12
  "And though one may be overpowered, two can resist. Moreover, a cord of three strands is not quickly broken."
- ☐ Proverbs 18:24
  "A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who stays closer than a brother."
- ☐ Psalm 62:8

"Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him. God is our refuge."

☐ Galatians 6:2
"Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

The verse I will practice:

Practicing the Truth

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5 Rehearse the truth daily

Read your chosen Scripture, listen, and practice a balanced thought.

Read Pearls: Trust. Listen to Overcoming Anxiety. Say your replacement truth aloud once in the morning and once in the evening.

Today I noticed this change:

6 Try a small behavioral experiment

Choose a safe, low-risk test; do not ignore real warning signs.

- ☐ Ask someone safe for one small, specific favor, and notice what happens.
- ☐ Delegate one small task this week and observe the result.
- ☐ List three people who have kept their word to you.
- ☐ Share a minor difficulty with one trusted person, and record how they responded.
- ☐ Make a small plan with someone and see whether they follow through.
- ☐ Write a prayer thanking God for His faithfulness, then name one person you could trust a little more.

My prediction:

What actually happened:

What I learned:

7 Track what changes

Practice for seven days. Mark what you tried and rate belief strength.

Day	What I practiced	Belief %	What I learned
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Song reflection

After listening to one of the four songs, write a sentence about trusting God and learning to trust again.

Song:

A truth I want to remember:

My Truth Card

OLD BELIEF:
~~Depending on anyone only leads to trouble.~~

NEW TRUTH:
Some people failed me, but not all will. I can depend on God fully and on safe people a little at a time.

MY SCRIPTURE:
Ecclesiastes 4:9–10

A short prayer

Lord, thank You that You never fail me. Help me to lean on You first and to trust wise, safe people in small steps. Amen.

Scripture quotations: Berean Standard Bible (BSB), public domain. Educational material only; not a diagnosis or substitute for professional care.